

The Contractor Record

Official findings involving the two companies contracted to deliver Alberta's disability employment services

This document records findings made by coroners, courts, ombudsmen, inspectorates, auditors general, parliamentary committees and human rights bodies concerning Serco and Angus Knight Group entities, in matters involving disabled people, chronically ill people, and people with mental health conditions.

It records what those bodies found. It does not allege that any of it will happen in Alberta. Every item states which company entity it attaches to, whether an adverse finding was made, and whether the person was established to be disabled. Findings favourable to the companies are recorded alongside findings against them.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown

St. Albert, Alberta | Second version, July 2026

How to read this record

Alberta awarded two prime contracts for disability employment services under solicitation AB-2025-06143, effective 1 April 2026. Serco Canada holds the South Zone contract, C15218, at \$50,941,933.78. AKG Canada holds the North Zone contract, C15192, at \$46,963,570.99. Both are subsidiaries of multinational groups with long records of delivering custodial, detention, health and employment services under government contract in other countries.

Those records are public, and they were public before the contracts were awarded. This document assembles the part of them that concerns disabled people.

The three categories

Collapsing these together is the fastest way to make a document like this worthless. Every item carries one.

Category	Meaning
(i) Adverse finding	A coroner, court, ombudsman or inquiry made a finding of fact naming the company or its staff.
(ii) No adverse finding	Death or harm occurred in a facility the company operated, but no adverse finding was made against it. In several cases the body expressly found the company's conduct adequate.
(iii) Not upheld	An allegation was made and rejected. Recorded here so that it cannot be presented as unresolved.

Evidence tiers

Tier 1 is a coroner, court, ombudsman, inspectorate, auditor general, parliamentary committee or regulator. **Tier 2** is major media. **Tier 3** is documentation by non-governmental organisations. Almost everything below is Tier 1. Where it is not, the item says so.

The disability marker

Each item states whether the source establishes that the person was disabled, chronically ill or had a mental health condition, or whether that is unstated. Where it is unstated, no assumption is made.

What has been left out, and why that matters

A long list of incidents commonly attributed to these companies is set out at Part 6, with the reason each one is excluded. Most concern facilities run by different operators altogether. Some were decided in the companies' favour. They are listed rather than quietly dropped, because a reader is entitled to know that the exclusions were made deliberately.

Limits of this record

This is a record of what has been examined, not a record of everything that has happened. Several matters identified during compilation could not be retrieved from primary sources and are therefore not stated here. They are listed at Part 7. Nothing in the body of this document rests on a source that was not read.

Part 0 — Which company is which

Both groups operate through many separate legal entities. A finding against one is not a finding against another, and this document keeps them apart throughout.

Serco entities

Entity	Role
Serco Group plc (UK)	Listed parent. Gave the 2019 undertaking to the UK Serious Fraud Office.
Serco Limited (UK)	UK contracting entity: prisons, immigration removal centres, and since September 2024 the Department for Work and Pensions functional assessment contract.
Serco Geografix Ltd (UK)	Subject of the 2019 Deferred Prosecution Agreement.
Serco Australia Pty Ltd	Onshore immigration detention 2009 to 2024; Australian prisons; Fiona Stanley Hospital.
Serco New Zealand Ltd	Mount Eden Corrections Facility 2011 to 2015; Auckland South Corrections Facility, current.
Serco Inc. (United States)	US federal contracts. No finding of harm to a disabled person was located.
Serco Canada Inc.	DriveTest subcontractor in Ontario. Alberta Prime Contractor South, C15218.

One correction worth recording. "Serco Care & Custody" does not exist. Care & Custody is a brand of a different company, Mitie. Several facilities commonly attributed to Serco are Mitie facilities.

Angus Knight Group entities

Entity	Role
AngusKnight Pty Limited	Australian parent, founded 1991, Sydney.
MAX Solutions / MAX Employment	Australian employment services. Acquired from Maximus during 2023 and 2024.
Jobfind	Original employment services arm.
AKG Canada	Alberta Prime Contractor North, C15192. Operating in Canada since 2006 through the inherited Maximus Canada business; nine service centres, mostly in British Columbia.
Jobs 22	United Kingdom joint venture with the charity Catch22. Holds the Department for Work and Pensions Restart Scheme contract for East Central England, covering more than 110,000 unemployed people.

The acquisition that changes the picture

Angus Knight Group acquired Maximus's employment services operations across Australia, Canada, Korea, Singapore, Italy and Sweden during 2023 and 2024. MAX Solutions, one of Australia's most heavily scrutinised employment services providers, is now an AKG company, and AKG Canada's Canadian history is the inherited Maximus Canada business.

The rule this document follows: conduct by MAX before the acquisition is Maximus's conduct, not AKG's. AKG bought the entity; it did not commit the earlier conduct. What is accurate is that the company Alberta contracted now owns those operations.

Part 1 — Serco, United Kingdom

Sean Williams

Died 27 March 2024, in a Serco escort van at Thames Magistrates' Court. Disability established: schizophrenia, unmedicated; the pathologist recorded sudden unexpected death in schizophrenia. Category (i). Tier 1.

A Prevention of Future Deaths report was issued on 20 February 2026 and sent to Serco Prison Transport Services. The jury found Serco's first aid training inadequate and its assessment of staff competence inadequate, and found that Serco failed to provide clear guidance on the emergency button procedures. The crew did not open his cell door for fifteen minutes. The coroner put to the Serco driver that the crew's focus was on anything except getting Mr Williams out of his cell, and the driver agreed.

The Prisons and Probation Ombudsman separately found that staff did not respond in a reasonable or justifiable manner, that Serco escort staff failed to follow their own local policy, that obtaining evidence from Serco is met with delay and obfuscation, and that senior Serco staff refused to have contact with the family. The Ombudsman records two further deaths in Serco transport custody since.

Source: Prevention of Future Deaths report 2026-0105, judiciary.uk; Prisons and Probation Ombudsman fatal incident report, ppo.gov.uk

FGP v Serco PLC and Secretary of State for the Home Department

[2012] EWHC 1804 (Admin), judgment 5 July 2012. Colnbrook Immigration Removal Centre, Serco era. Disability established: medicated depression, history of self-harm and a suicide attempt, acute physical illness requiring an eight-day inpatient stay. Category (i), in part. Tier 1.

Restraints used during three short hospital visits were held not to breach the claimant's rights. For the eight-day inpatient stay, the court found a failure to appreciate that restraints should only be applied during treatment if regarded as necessary, and held that this failure led to restraints being applied when they were not needed, amounting to a breach of Article 3.

The finding on responsibility is the part that carries forward: the court held that the contractor is primarily responsible for safeguarding the human rights of the detainees under its control. The parallel challenge to Home Office policy failed.

Source: bailii.org, [2012] EWHC 1804 (Admin)

Sivaraj Tharmalingam

Died 18 April 2015, Thames Magistrates' Court custody. Disability established: epilepsy, permanent brain damage, alcohol dependence; the escort record flagged all three together with suicidal thoughts. Category (i). Jury conclusion, Tier 1, relayed through Tier 3.

The inquest jury concluded that failures by the police, Serco and the forensic medical examiner contributed to the death. The jury found that Serco's cell checks were random and that none were documented. Serco's own witness accepted that the computer log was a work of fiction.

Source: INQUEST, inquest conclusion

Gerard Scahill

Died 22 April 2016, HMP Doncaster, operated by Serco. Disability established: long history of mental health issues and substance abuse. Category (i). Jury conclusion, Tier 1, relayed through Tier 3.

The jury found that Serco prison staff did not adequately and effectively manage the threats and bullying that Mr Scahill reported, and that this was causative of death. Healthcare failures in the same inquest were attributed to the NHS Trust rather than to Serco.

Source: INQUEST, inquest conclusion

Kevin Smith

Died 22 April 2023, HMP Doncaster, operated by Serco. Aged 18. Disability established: ADHD, medicated; on the caseload of the prison's learning disabilities nurse; extensive self-harm history. Category (i). Tier 1.

The Prisons and Probation Ombudsman found that suicide-prevention support ended with insufficient exploration of his concerns, and that officers did not make a routine check of prisoners at 6.15am, described as a serious breach of security. The Ombudsman had again identified deficiencies in the operation of the key-worker scheme, following two earlier deaths at the same prison. Two recommendations were directed to the Serco director.

A separate finding in the same report, that his mental health care was not equivalent to that available in the community, was directed at the healthcare provider and not at Serco.

Source: Prisons and Probation Ombudsman fatal incident report, ppo.gov.uk

Adam Rickwood

Died 8 August 2004, Hassockfield Secure Training Centre, operated by Serco. Aged 14. Disability not established; vulnerability was found to contribute, but no diagnosed condition is recorded. Category (i). Tier 1 through Tier 3.

At the second inquest all parties agreed that the removal from association and the restraint used were in breach of the Home Office and Serco contract, and unlawful. The jury found a serious system failure giving rise to an unlawful regime.

Source: INQUEST, second inquest conclusion

Gareth Chumber-Kelly

Died 17 July 2023, HMP Pentonville. Serco was an addressee of the Prevention of Future Deaths report. Disability established: history of self-harm, two prior suicide attempts, opioid dependence with withdrawal. Category (i), narrow. Tier 1.

The jury concluded that he took his own life and that the risk of his doing so was not recognised. A suicide and self-harm warning form was sent to the prison via Serco; the accompanying report was missing on arrival, and the inquest heard it was quite common for forms meant to accompany prisoners to go missing. The Governor said there had been no dialogue with Serco to address the issue.

Attribution matters here. Pentonville is a public sector prison and Serco's role was escort and document transfer. Most of the criticism fell on the prison service.

Source: Prevention of Future Deaths report, judiciary.uk

Facility conditions, where no adverse finding on a death was made

Yarl's Wood Immigration Removal Centre

Operated by Serco Limited since April 2007 and currently. Category (ii). Tier 1.

His Majesty's Inspectorate of Prisons reported in October 2023 that 84 per cent of detainees said they had felt depressed and 44 per cent said they had felt suicidal, and that at least two psychotic detainees who were not well enough to be detained were held in separation for extended periods. Findings on separation were assigned to the Home Office and to centre management. Findings on mental capacity and health were assigned to the Home Office and the health trust.

Source: HM Inspectorate of Prisons, October 2023

Brook House Immigration Removal Centre

Operated by G4S until 20 May 2020 and by Serco Limited from 21 May 2020. Category (ii). Tier 1.

The August 2024 inspection found safety and respect had both fallen to not sufficiently good, and that 35 per cent of detainees said they had felt suicidal. Health provision was found inadequate, but assigned to the health provider, against which the regulator found a breach. Concerns assigned to Serco were rising use of force with leaders having not made sufficient use of data, routine handcuffing of detainees on external escorts, and limited awareness of diverse needs.

In the death of Alfred Dosku at the same centre on 17 November 2023, the Prisons and Probation Ombudsman was satisfied that staff could not have foreseen his actions and made no recommendations. The allegation that staff had been told of his suicidal statements was not upheld. That is recorded here as category (ii) and (iii).

Source: HM Inspectorate of Prisons, August 2024; Prisons and Probation Ombudsman fatal incident report

Brian Dalrymple

Died 31 July 2011, Colnbrook, then operated by Serco. Disability established: schizophrenia and severe hypertension. Category (ii), with a caution.

The jury found death by natural causes contributed to by neglect. Most of the failings, however, occurred at a different centre operated by a different company over a period of six weeks; he was at Colnbrook for approximately three and a half days. The neglect finding is not discrete to Serco and should not be presented as though it were. The Prevention of Future Deaths report went to five addressees, of which Serco was one, and only one responded.

Source: Prevention of Future Deaths report 2014-0410, judiciary.uk

The assessment contract, and why it is the closest comparison

Serco now assesses disabled people's benefit entitlement in the United Kingdom

Serco held no work capability or personal independence payment assessment contract between 2005 and 2024; those were held by other companies. Since September 2024 Serco has held the Department for Work and Pensions Functional Assessment Services contract for South West England, worth approximately £350 million, delivering work capability assessments and personal independence payment assessments.

This is the closest existing comparison to what Serco Canada has been contracted to do in southern Alberta.

No death and no coroner's finding links Serco to benefit assessments or to employment programme sanctions. The judiciary's Prevention of Future Deaths archive, the National Audit Office, the Work and Pensions Committee, Hansard and the specialist disability press were all searched. That is a clean negative result and it is recorded as one. It should be read with the contract's age in mind: it is less than two years old, so the absence of findings may reflect an absence of scrutiny rather than an absence of harm.

Part 2 — Serco, Australia

Two corrections that matter before anything else

The contract period is 2009 to 2024, not to the present. Serco Australia held the onshore immigration detention contract from June 2009 until 10 December 2024. Serco Group plc announced on 8 November 2024 that it had been unsuccessful in rebidding. A different company has held it since March 2025.

Offshore detention was never Serco. Manus Island and Nauru were operated by other companies entirely. The word Serco does not appear in the Queensland Coroner's findings on the best known offshore death, in the Senate committee's contractor chapter, or in the national audit of offshore contract management. Christmas Island, by contrast, was part of the onshore network and was Serco. This is the distinction most often garbled.

Contract value grew from \$279.22 million at signature to \$1.67 billion over five years according to the national auditor. The Commonwealth's National Preventive Mechanism put the total at more than \$4 billion over ten years.

Villawood, 2010: three deaths in three months

Josefa Rauluni, Ahmed Obeid Al-Akabi and David Saunders. New South Wales State Coroner, findings 19 December 2011. Disability established: deteriorating mental states are the core of the finding. Category (i). Tier 2 only, and therefore stated without quotation.

The coroner found that the department, Serco Australia and the health services contractor failed to recognise and properly care for the three men's deteriorating mental states, that communications between agencies were lacking, that staff were poorly trained, and that staff were unprepared and untrained for the events preceding one of the deaths.

This is recorded without direct quotation. The findings document could not be obtained from the court, which does not appear to publish findings from that period online, and the characterisations above derive from contemporaneous news agency reporting rather than from the findings themselves. It is included because the finding is well attested and central; it is stated at this level of generality because the primary document has not been read.

Robert Elan Peihopa

Died 4 April 2016, Villawood. Deputy State Coroner, 28 November 2017. Disability established: chronic coronary artery disease. Category (i). Tier 1.

Closed circuit television showed him collapse at 9.26pm. The coroner found there was no Serco response until 9.43pm, a gap of seventeen minutes. Serco's post-incident review omitted its own intelligence holdings, which a departmental witness called a serious omission. The coroner found that neither the department nor Serco conducted their own investigations into the events leading to the death, and that Serco's position that it was inappropriate to draw conclusions appeared inconsistent with its contractual obligation. Serco's centre manager did not accept that Serco had any responsibility.

Nine recommendations were made, six directed at Serco or at the department and Serco jointly. The coroner declined to set a staffing ratio, finding there was insufficient evidence.

This is a finding on incident response, investigation and information sharing. It is not a finding that Serco caused the death.

Source: NSW Coroners Court, findings 28 November 2017

Fazel Chegeni Nejad

Died between 6 and 8 November 2015, Christmas Island. Coroner's findings 2 May 2019, open finding. Disability established: an acute stress reaction and adjustment disorder on a background of emotionally unstable personality disorder; the coroner found he came into detention with pre-existing vulnerabilities exacerbated by lengthy detention. Category (i), with a large category (ii) component. Tier 1.

The coroner recorded that the Commonwealth is responsible for the centre's structures including its security systems, and that it is the responsibility of Serco to manage the facility within the structure provided.

On the control room, the coroner found that deficiencies limited the ability to detect and respond, that the two operators had experience next to none and no idea whatsoever what the alarms meant, and that while all three men involved were disciplined there was an overriding failure in the system that must come down to the decision to have untrained staff in charge of the control room without proper supervision. He found it was unreasonable to expect those two officers to operate the control room on their own that evening, that more should have been done to ensure someone with proper knowledge was in charge, and that any written guidelines were not drawn to their attention in any meaningful way. He also recorded that there was sometimes a lag of a day or two between Serco receiving a medical request form and forwarding it to the health provider.

The balancing findings are extensive. The coroner recorded significant steps taken by Serco on control room operation and officer training and was satisfied the failings would not be repeated, accepting that the training is now of an appropriate standard. He made no criticism of the way the search was conducted. He found there seemed to be a relatively good understanding by Serco staff that Mr Chegeni Nejad was suffering from mental health issues and might be at risk, and that when he behaved in a concerning manner Serco staff and his case managers took steps to have him medically assessed. Perimeter fencing responsibility rested with the Commonwealth. The central adverse findings on the transfer decision attach to the Commonwealth. A family allegation of egregious failings against a treating doctor was rejected.

Exactly two recommendations were made, both directed to the Commonwealth and the health provider. None was directed at Serco. The coroner considered one touching Serco, agreed it should be adopted, and then expressly declined to make a formal recommendation in that regard. This is verified against the full findings, not the court's summary.

Source: Coroner's Court of Western Australia, findings 2 May 2019, 123 pages

Moses Kellie

Died 25 January 2019, Villawood. Disability established: schizophrenia, post-traumatic stress disorder and substance dependence, diagnosed 2010. Category (ii) and (iii). Tier 1.

The coroner largely declined to make adverse findings against Serco, holding that the role contemplated for Serco staff did not require medical training or clinical expertise, that the support plan provided detention officers with sufficient guidance, and that the evidence did not enable a clear finding that his declining mental health ought to have been noticeable to detention staff before early January.

Recommendations were nonetheless directed at Serco by name, concerning support plan responsibilities, recognising signs and symptoms of mental illness or deterioration, welfare check practice, and personal officer training. Serco did not oppose the welfare check recommendation; the Commonwealth did.

Source: NSW Coroners Court, inquest findings

Leah Jane Porter

Died 22 May 2022, Villawood. Disability established: ADHD and depression, later a personality disorder diagnosis, serious self-harm attempts. Category (ii). Tier 1.

The central finding is favourable to the providers. The coroner held that the evidence supported the conclusion that the monitoring, treatment and support given was adequate, and declined the majority of the recommendations proposed by counsel assisting.

Two adverse elements are recorded: a specific deficiency in the centre's support plan process, and a finding that after a room search more consideration ought to have been given to her welfare, an officer's check having been made on her own initiative rather than under any policy. This item should not be presented as an adverse finding.

Source: NSW Coroners Court, inquest findings

Muhammad Hafizuddin Bin Zaini

Died 12 December 2020, Villawood, operated by Serco Australia Pty Ltd. Aged 29. Disability established: a resolving substance-induced psychotic disorder, with depressive and anxiety symptoms. Category (ii), no adverse finding. Tier 1. This entry is recorded because it is favourable to the operator.

Serco was a represented party. Every reference to Serco in the findings is descriptive. Detention officers recorded and escalated his statements, an officer cut him down and began resuscitation with a colleague, and a Serco officer had earlier defused an incident which he accepted and apologised for.

The coroner was satisfied that the monitoring and treatment he received for his mental health while in immigration detention was adequate, that the response to missed appointments and medication non-compliance was adequate, and that the risk he would take his life by these means could not reasonably have been foreseen. Counsel assisting's characterisation of certain communications as inadequate or harmful was not adopted.

The adverse findings that exist attach to the Commonwealth, and both recommendations were expressly directed to the Commonwealth. None was directed at Serco.

Source: Coroners Court of New South Wales, Deputy State Coroner, findings 6 March 2025

Kenneth Douglas Wright

Died 20 March 2015, Southern Queensland Correctional Centre, operated by Serco. Aged 71. Disability established: moderate cognitive impairment, acquired brain injury, underlying dementia, bedridden; the Public Guardian had been appointed six weeks earlier. Category (i). Tier 1.

The coroner found that a failure to act was not consistent with good nursing practice, and that this represented a failure in the emergency response. Oxygen saturation was recorded at 77 per cent at 1.33pm; no treatment followed until he was found deceased at 2.40pm; no ambulance was called before the emergency code. A recommendation was directed at Serco by name regarding ambulance attendance processes.

The balancing findings are required. The coroner also found that care in the unit was generally of a high standard, that there was no guarantee a different response would have changed the outcome, and accepted Serco's submission that the absent ambulance could not be said to have been directly causative. This is not a finding that Serco caused the death.

Source: Queensland Coroner, findings 3 August 2018

Jomen Blanket

Died 12 June 2019, Acacia Prison, Western Australia. The coroner recorded that Serco Australia Pty Ltd privately operated Acacia under an agreement with the department and was responsible for the prison's operational and maintenance services. Aged 30. Noongar and Torres Strait Islander man. Disability established: self-harm, suicidal ideation, suspected psychosis, treated by the mental health team and a consultant psychiatrist. Category (i), with a substantial category (ii) component. Tier 1.

The coroner found that it was grossly inadequate that there were only six safe cells out of 1059 at the prison, four of them in the detention unit, leaving two the coroner regarded as appropriate. He was satisfied to the required standard that the lack of an appropriate number of suitable safe cells was a contributing factor in the death. He also found that an error in allowing Mr Blanket to close his cell door while at elevated risk with a known suicide plan was a contributing factor, expressly declining to attribute that error to any individual.

Four years of non-implementation of Serco's own post-incident review recommendation for safe cells in the relevant block was described as extremely disappointing, and the coroner recorded a significant degree of apathy from the department and Serco. He was very concerned that Serco appeared unaware of a provision in the at-risk management manual concerning prisoner attendance at case reviews. Of seven recommendations, one is directed at Serco by name.

The balancing findings are substantial and must travel with the above. The coroner's overall conclusion was that the standard of supervision, treatment and care of Mr Blanket at the prison with respect to his mental health was appropriate, with two exceptions, and that those factors blighted what was otherwise an appropriate and at times very high standard. He found the risk management plans very effective and rigorously applied, described a prompt move to a safe cell as commendable foresight, and praised a staff member's actions as deserving of high praise. On cultural appropriateness he was satisfied that every effort was made, with the resources available, to offer culturally appropriate treatment and care, and recorded that Serco employed a First Nations prison support officer who provided cultural expertise. He found that the prison's mental health service providers did their very best with the limited time and resources they had. Three proposed recommendations were dropped, including one on training, the coroner finding that prison officers were receiving adequate training. He expressly guarded against hindsight bias.

Source: Coroner's Court of Western Australia, [2023] WACOR 6, findings 21 August 2023

Stanley John Inman

Died 13 July 2020, Acacia Prison, operated by Serco. Aged 19. Noongar and Wirlomin man. Disability established: mental health and self-harm risk. Category (ii). Tier 1.

The coroner found that the overall quality of his supervision, treatment and care was of a lower standard than it should have been, because his level of risk was not properly understood. The coroner named no Serco entity or officer as at fault and made no recommendations, holding that it was not necessary to do so.

The findings record the prison's Aboriginal staffing: five of 264 prison officers, none of twelve psychologists and social workers, and no Aboriginal Visitors Scheme staff.

Source: Coroner's Court of Western Australia

Ian Head

Died 25 August 2022, Acacia Prison, operated by Serco. Aged about 75. Disability established: received a disability pension from 2003; chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, hypertension, stage 2 chronic renal failure. Natural causes. Category (ii) and (iii). Tier 1.

The coroner was satisfied that his treatment, supervision and care was commensurate with community standards, and made no recommendations. This is recorded as a finding favourable to the operator.

The systemic material in the same findings is usable without being framed as fault: only a head count was conducted at 6.20am due to staff shortages; the department's Director of Medical Services said the prison was probably running with inadequate general practitioner cover for the patient load; and the coroner noted a perceived pattern at the prison of pushing back scheduled medical review dates.

Source: Coroner's Court of Western Australia

Dictor Dongrin

*Died 13 June 2022, Clarence Correctional Centre, Grafton, New South Wales, operated by Serco Australia Pty Ltd. Aged 29, approximately 26 hours after entering custody. Disability established: the reception checklist recorded, against the question asking about physical or intellectual impairment or disability, the answer yes, seizures due to alcohol withdrawals. Active seizures since 2018 and a hospital admission for alcohol withdrawal within the previous six months. Category (i), naming both the company and its staff. Tier 1. **This is the most severe coronial finding against Serco in this record, and the most recent.***

The coroner found the manner of death to be that timely and adequate medical treatment and management of his alcohol withdrawal at the centre could have prevented his death.

From the completion of the intake assessment until the time of death, the coroner found, his treatment, healthcare and management by health staff at the centre was wholly inadequate, and that the evidence is indicative of systematic complacency and incompetence. The failure to carry out any further assessment was found to be grossly inadequate. The coroner found that he was powerless to protect himself and that those charged with housing him, Serco, failed to provide appropriate care. She found that the clinical structure in place created uncertainty and confusion about where responsibilities lay, and that a product of that uncertainty was that no one took ultimate responsibility, resulting in his preventable death. No clinical observations were taken after the initial assessment until the time of death; counsel for the family described it as a cruel irony that he died in a clinical observation cell in circumstances where no clinical observations were taken.

Correctional officers' failure to have regard to the health problem notification form gave rise to missed opportunities, and one officer asserted that the training provided to her by Serco was inadequate. The coroner recorded that while Serco has taken some steps to address the systemic failures brought to light by the death, there remains more work to do. Serco's submission that the death could not be found preventable was expressly rejected.

The balancing findings are real and are recorded here. The nurse who conducted the reception assessment, a Serco employee, was exonerated and praised: her assessment was found thorough and appropriate, her decision to consult the doctor was said to demonstrate proactivity and critical thinking, and the coroner rejected a suggestion that she needed more information before acting. The adverse finding is expressly bounded as beginning after her intake. Her inability to record a blood pressure was found to be a system limitation rather than a failing, and drove recommendations directed at a health-records system defect rather than at Serco. The coroner accepted substantial remediation, including a new default of two-hourly observations, mandatory pre-placement clinical assessment, in-service training with written acknowledgement, daily handover rounds and a correctional officer training package, and noted that had the new two-hourly default been in place the death may have been

prevented. Part of the confusion was attributed to a health network policy predating Serco's own procedure. The records-access gap was expressly found not to be Serco's doing. A separately represented doctor's failings were found not to have been undertaken in isolation. There was no finding of breach of contract and no adverse finding against Serco's general manager or health services director.

Three recommendations are directed at Serco by name: an audit of health staff on alcohol withdrawal management and on compliance with Serco's own procedures for patients in clinical observation cells and for escalating health concerns, with training revised if the audit shows it necessary; revision of local operating procedures to remove ambiguity about who may place a patient in an observation cell, about the allocation of responsibility between drug and alcohol and primary healthcare staff, and about the ongoing requirement to administer clinical observations; and a procedure for recording comments against clinical observations. Two Serco-engaged nurses were referred to the Nursing and Midwifery Council of New South Wales for review of their conduct, and a doctor to the Medical Council.

Source: Coroners Court of New South Wales, Deputy State Coroner, findings 11 June 2026

Oversight body findings

Australian Human Rights Commission, Use of force in immigration detention

[2019] AusHRC 130. *The most disability-specific document in the Australian record. Category (i). Tier 1.*

Fourteen complaints were examined and a breach of the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights was found in nine. Serco is named throughout. Among the findings: a man with schizoaffective disorder was extracted days after five weeks as a psychiatric inpatient, with the Commission not satisfied that his mental health issues were sufficiently taken into account; a man was handcuffed for external medical appointments in a manner found neither reasonable nor proportionate, with restraints used on two occasions before approval was received; a man was handcuffed over an open wrist wound for at least eight and a half hours; downward force applied to a man's head against concrete dislodged an implanted tooth; and in another case the Commission found that the actions of Serco officers caused a situation to escalate into an avoidable use of force.

Systemic findings included restraints applied to two men in wheelchairs, spit hoods authorised where officers are given no training in their use, and detainees who refused handcuffs being asked to sign forms recording that they had refused treatment.

The department did not agree that any of the conduct complained of involved a breach of human rights. That response is recorded here rather than left for an opponent to supply.

Source: Australian Human Rights Commission, [2019] AusHRC 130

Commonwealth Ombudsman, Monitoring Immigration Detention, January to June 2020

Category (i). Tier 1.

Two of twenty use-of-force reports reviewed showed force that may have been excessive or inappropriate, and Serco had acknowledged in one case that the use of force could have been avoided. The Ombudsman recorded a practice of mandatory ground stabilisation, under which detainees were physically restrained on the floor when placed in solitary confinement even where the detainee was complying with instructions.

The disability finding is direct: the Ombudsman observed a lack of differentiation in the risk associated with a physical altercation related to a detainee's mental health condition as against a violent unprovoked attack, and found this drove placement decisions, medical waiting lists and the use of mechanical restraints. Medical services were the single largest complaint category in the period, at 29 of 114.

Source: Commonwealth Ombudsman, January to June 2020

Commonwealth National Preventive Mechanism, OPCAT in Action, 2025

The most recent and the most directly relevant to contract design. Category (i). Tier 1.

The report records that Serco was paid a sum exceeding \$4 billion over ten years. Its central finding for present purposes concerns what happened when contractual penalties lapsed. In Serco's final three months financial abatements were not available to be imposed, followed by a grace period for the successor, producing a six-month period in which the border force was largely powerless to enforce many standards. The report finds that conditions within the detention network dramatically deteriorated in that time.

Staff told monitors that Serco appeared disinterested in upholding service standards and meeting contractual obligations. The report finds that the failures resulted in serious impacts including people in detention being unable to access appropriate health services.

Serco's response is annexed to the report. It accepts some observations and expressly does not accept findings on poor maintenance or that hostility between providers affected service delivery.

Source: Commonwealth National Preventive Mechanism, OPCAT in Action: Onshore Immigration Detention, 2025

Joint Select Committee on Australia's Immigration Detention Network

Final report 30 March 2012. Chapter 3 is titled The Department's administration of its contract with Serco. Category (i). Tier 1.

The committee saw detainees on suicide watch kept within 1.5 metres of a Serco officer with thirty minute checks. The department, the health provider and Serco all said this was not required by policy, and the health provider confirmed it was not its policy and had not been approved by it. The procedure had been prepared by Serco. The Detention Health Advisory Group considered its implementation to be extremely damaging to detainees.

The committee also recorded that the workplace safety regulator found the department had failed to ensure that Serco staff were sufficiently trained.

Source: Parliament of Australia, Joint Select Committee final report, 30 March 2012

New South Wales Inspector of Custodial Services, Clarence Correctional Centre, 2024

Serco Australia Pty Ltd operates Clarence Correctional Centre. Category (i). Tier 1.

The inspection found that the adequacy of health services was a major concern and that the mental health team in particular was grossly understaffed. The consultant forensic psychiatrist was recorded as gravely concerned by the level of unmanaged risk. The report records that access to a service was reportedly denied because Serco is a private provider, with the consequence that the centre cannot deliver continuity of care as patients move between facilities. Recommendation 37 was that Serco increase the number of positions in the mental health team.

In 2025 two notices of major default were issued, one following a death in custody by an unnatural cause in March 2025. Serco's recorded position was that financial abatements were impacting its ability to innovate.

Source: NSW Inspector of Custodial Services, Inspection of Clarence Correctional Centre 2024

Australian National Audit Office, health services in onshore immigration detention

Tier 1.

The audit found monitoring insufficient, most notably in community detention, mental health care, medication management, and timely and clinically appropriate access to health services. Only nine of seventeen performance measures had an appropriate methodology as at March 2016. The audit records that 30 per cent of detainees are diagnosed with a mental health problem warranting regular mental health services, against 12 per cent of the Australian population.

One correction, because the error circulates. The figure of \$300,000 abated in the first six months, frequently attributed to Serco, refers to the health services contractor. It is not a Serco figure.

Source: Australian National Audit Office

Where Serco operated in Australia, and when

Facility or contract	Serco period
Onshore immigration detention network	June 2009 – 10 December 2024
Acacia Prison, Western Australia	2006 – present
Wandoo, Western Australia	November 2012 – 1 May 2018
Southern Queensland Correctional Centre	approx. 2012 – 1 July 2021
Clarence Correctional Centre, NSW (subcontractor)	1 July 2020 – present
Adelaide Remand Centre, South Australia	2019 – present, renewed 8 May 2026
Western Australia court security and custodial transport	to March 2017
Fiona Stanley Hospital, non-clinical services	July 2011 – 2027

Events at Wandoo after 1 May 2018 and at Southern Queensland Correctional Centre after 1 July 2021 are not Serco matters.

Part 3 — Serco, New Zealand, the United States and Canada

Mount Eden Corrections Facility

Operated by Serco New Zealand from August 2011; the department stepped in on 24 July 2015. Category (i). Tier 1.

The Chief Inspector's Phase One Report of 8 December 2015 found that organised prisoner fighting at the facility produced serious injuries requiring hospitalisation, including broken limbs and brain damage, and that these were reported to the department's national office by Serco as an accident, or not at all. On supervision, the report records staff observed playing pool or table tennis.

This finding needs to be stated precisely to be usable. It establishes that people in a Serco-run facility sustained brain damage, which is harm that creates lifelong disability, and that qualifying serious assaults were misclassified or not reported. It does not establish that the injured men were disabled beforehand.

The report also records that 12.7 per cent of the facility's population were receiving mental health care, and documents a prisoner nominated to fight without his consent who reported that his cellmate was also at risk and that unit staff generally turned a blind eye.

Source: New Zealand Office of the Inspectorate, Chief Inspector's Phase One Report, 8 December 2015

Auckland South Corrections Facility

Operated by Serco New Zealand under a twenty-five year public private partnership. Serco was and remains the operator, so attribution is not complicated by any step-in. Category (i). Tier 1. These are the most direct disability findings in the record.

The Office of the Inspectorate's announced inspection of April 2021 found that one prisoner with a congenital disorder and other health conditions, with limited mobility, did not receive a wheelchair to use in his unit for his first week in prison, and that being unable to move contributed to a deterioration in his condition. A second wheelchair user had been bullied by prisoners he shared a cell with and made to sleep on the top bunk. The inspection found that the site does not always accurately record which prisoners have disabilities or the nature of their disability. Twenty-one prisoners were on the high risk register with high and complex needs.

The Chief Ombudsman's inspection of August 2018, published February 2019, found that requests for health or disability-related assistance were slow to be actioned. Two wheelchairs were fit for short-term use only and caused the prisoners pain, and the prisoners' recorded concern was that difficulty manoeuvring them might contribute to further degeneration of their health. Thirty-six recommendations were made.

That report is mixed and should be presented as such. It commends the operator on physical accessibility and on at-risk cell practice, and records prisoners with visual impairments and an amputee working in prison industries. The wheelchair findings stand on their own.

Source: NZ Office of the Inspectorate, April 2021; NZ Chief Ombudsman, published 20 February 2019

United States

Negative result, recorded as such.

No evidence of any death or serious physical harm to a disabled person attributable to Serco Inc. in the United States was located. The public record concerning the federal health insurance marketplace contract concerns cost, idleness and contract management rather than harm, and no audit office or inspector general finding links the company to patient harm. The literature on contracted veterans' disability examinations does not name the company. Serco does not operate United States immigration detention.

One matter is recorded because citing it as misconduct would be an error: a False Claims Act allegation against Serco Inc. was decided in the company's favour on appeal in January 2017.

Canada, before Alberta

Negative result, recorded as such.

No inquest, coroner's finding or auditor general adverse finding involving Serco Canada Inc. was located. The Ontario driver examination fraud matter, in which individuals alleged in court filings to have acted as agents of Serco Canada Inc. face criminal charges and the company itself has not been charged, is dealt with separately in the campaign's contractor oversight addendum.

Part 4 — Angus Knight Group

The finding on AKG is a negative one, and it survives a proper search

No coronial inquest, court judgment or official inquiry into the death of any participant, client or employee connected to an Angus Knight Group entity or its programs was located in any Australian coronial jurisdiction, in Australian case law, or in the United Kingdom.

No adverse official finding naming any AKG entity was located.

What was searched, and what could not be

The search covered Australian case law, the disability services enforcement register in full, the Commonwealth Ombudsman, the Fair Work Commission, all eight Australian coronial jurisdictions, and in the United Kingdom the Prevention of Future Deaths archive, Hansard, the National Audit Office, the Public Accounts Committee and the companies register. It was run against the parent company and against the acquired entities: MAX Employment, MAX Solutions, Jobfind, Joblife and the remote programs.

The disability services enforcement register was pulled in full rather than sampled, at 3,673 records, and returns nothing for any AKG entity. That is an exhaustive negative and is stated as one.

Four sources could not be searched and are recorded as gaps rather than as negatives: the Australian parliamentary full-text database and the British and Irish legal information institute both blocked automated access; the United Kingdom information regulator's enforcement register is not machine readable; and nineteen confidential and thirty-four scanned parliamentary submissions could not be read.

A correction to an earlier version of this document

An earlier draft stated that AKG's record is thin because it has not been examined. That is wrong and it has been removed.

AKG has been examined, and it participated openly. It lodged a submission to the 2023 parliamentary inquiry into employment services under its own name; Jobfind and MAX Solutions lodged three more between them; and Jobfind's chief executive gave oral evidence identifying the company as part of the Angus Knight Group. The committee cited AKG across fourteen pages of its final report and cited it favourably as evidence against compulsory mutual obligations. It made no adverse finding against any AKG entity, which appear throughout as ordinary industry stakeholders.

The record is thin because a broad search across sixteen official databases found almost nothing adverse. That is a weaker sentence in tone and a far stronger one in substance.

Litigation involving the acquired entities

Thirteen judgments involving MAX entities were retrieved and read in full. None contains an adverse official finding against any MAX entity, and all concern conduct before the acquisition, so any finding would in any event have attached to the previous owner.

The most substantial is a four-day trial in Western Australia in 2018, in which claims of assault, negligence causing psychological injury and defamation were all dismissed on their merits. The court found that an alleged assault was either a figment of the plaintiff's imagination or a fabrication, that he had not proved he was treated unfairly or inappropriately, and that each of the employees dealt with him with respect and appropriately in accordance with their professional duties and training. The court found no evidence of any conspiracy or cover-up.

Two passages that sound adverse are disclosed here rather than omitted, because an opponent would find them. In a 2015 unfair dismissal matter that was dismissed for want of jurisdiction, the tribunal observed that had the applicant not been covered by an enterprise agreement making a particular provision, he may have been found to have been unfairly terminated. That is a conditional hypothetical and not a finding; the conduct was held lawful. In a 2013 interlocutory ruling that went the company's way, the commissioner said a prohibition on a worker contacting witnesses appeared at first glance arbitrary and perhaps unjust, while expressly stating that the evidence did not permit a finding that the conduct was unreasonable.

Two qualifications on the strength of all this. Most of the dismissals were on jurisdictional, limitation or pleading grounds rather than a decision on the merits, the 2018 trial being the exception. And thirteen judgments of seventy-nine returned were read, so the correct statement is that no adverse finding appears in the thirteen retrieved.

AKG Canada

AKG Canada states that it has delivered government-funded employment programs since 2006, inheriting the Maximus Canada employment services history, and that most of its services are delivered in British Columbia, where it operates nine service centres. Its self-reported and unaudited 2025 figures are more than 12,500 people served, more than 4,600 clients with disabilities, 55 per cent of disability clients placed into sustainable employment, and 76 per cent still employed at one year.

AKG Canada is a British Columbia operator with no Alberta delivery history.

A confusion to avoid

A different Maximus subsidiary held British Columbia's medical services plan and pharmacare administration contract from 2004, which generated real controversy including privacy concerns, a performance penalty and a records breach. That was health administration, not employment services, it was a different subsidiary, and it was not part of what AKG acquired. Attributing it to AKG Canada would be a serious error.

United Kingdom exposure

Jobs 22, a joint venture between AKG and the charity Catch22, won the Department for Work and Pensions Restart Scheme contract for East Central England in 2021, covering more than 110,000 unemployed people. No regulatory findings on that contract were searched.

Part 5 — Why this bears on Alberta

Four propositions are supported by the record above, and no more than four.

1. Serco is now in the disability assessment business, and Alberta is not the first

The Department for Work and Pensions contract awarded in September 2024 means Serco assesses disabled people's benefit entitlement in South West England. Alberta has contracted Serco Canada to assess and case-manage disability assistance clients in the south of the province. There is no published performance record for the United Kingdom contract yet, which is a reason for attention rather than for reassurance.

2. Where Serco has held disability-adjacent contracts, oversight bodies have repeatedly directed recommendations at it by name

On mental health monitoring, welfare checks, staffing levels, restraint during medical escorts, emergency response, and post-incident investigation. That is a pattern across four jurisdictions and fifteen years, documented by coroners, ombudsmen and inspectorates rather than by advocates.

3. When contractual penalties lapsed, an official monitoring body found that conditions deteriorated and people could not access health services

This is the sharpest available argument for why the audit rights and abatement provisions in Alberta's contracts matter, and why the fact that Alberta's contract template is not publicly readable is a live problem rather than a technicality. The Commonwealth's own preventive mechanism found that a six-month enforcement gap produced dramatic deterioration, and that the resulting failures left people unable to access appropriate health services.

4. A national oversight body has found that in a comparable mutual-obligation employment system, providers' decisions caused unlawful loss of income at scale, and oversight of those providers was inadequate

In December 2025 the Commonwealth Ombudsman published an investigation into the oversight of decisions made by employment service providers affecting job seekers. It found 985 unlawful cancellation decisions affecting 964 people between April 2022 and July 2024. Cancellation means the loss of four weeks of income support and a fresh application to resume payment.

The distribution of that harm is the part that bears on Alberta. First Nations people made up 46 per cent of those unlawfully cancelled against a 16 per cent share of the caseload, and 24 per cent of those affected had one or more recorded vulnerability indicators, including psychiatric problems or mental illness and illness or injury requiring frequent treatment.

Four of the report's eight findings go directly to contractor oversight: a high rate of provider decisions are overturned on review, with the agency finding large numbers of job seekers were not capable of meeting their plan requirements; automatic suspensions undermine a job seeker's capacity to engage; the department's assessment of provider performance lacks transparency, particularly in awarding moderate ratings where there is insufficient data to support them; and compliance activity against providers does not appear to align with the high rate at which their decisions are overturned.

What this finding does and does not say

It does not name AKG, Jobfind or MAX, and it must not be presented as though it does. No adverse finding attaches to any of them.

What it establishes is that the framework their Australian operations work within has been found by a national oversight body to produce unlawful outcomes at scale, falling disproportionately on First Nations people and on people with psychiatric and chronic health conditions, with provider performance assessment found to lack transparency and enforcement found not to match the rate of overturned decisions.

Alberta has now built a mutual-obligation employment system for disability income recipients, delivered by private providers, in which the placement determination is not appealable. That is the comparison, and it is a comparison of systems rather than of companies.

5. AKG's record is a genuine negative, and it is stated as one

The company contracted for the north is a seven-country group that has absorbed the previous owner's employment services operations across six jurisdictions and holds a United Kingdom welfare-to-work contract. A search across sixteen official databases, including the full disability services enforcement register, found no death, sanction, banning order or contract termination attaching to any AKG entity. Four sources could not be searched and are recorded as gaps at Part 7.

What this document does not say

It does not say that any of this has happened in Alberta, or that it will. It does not say that either company caused any death. Where a coroner found that a company's conduct was adequate, that finding is recorded here alongside the others. What the document establishes is that both companies came to Alberta with a public record, that the record was available before the contracts were awarded, and that no Alberta body has published any review of either contract.

Part 6 — What has been excluded, and why

Each of the following is commonly attributed to one of these companies. Each would be used to discredit this document if it were included. They are listed rather than quietly omitted.

Matter	Reason for exclusion
Deaths at Manus Island and Nauru	Operated by other companies entirely. Serco never held an offshore contract.
The 2017 Brook House abuse inquiry	G4S era. Serco took over the centre on 21 May 2020.
Home Affairs Committee disability cases, including a blind detainee held over a year and a wheelchair user who self-immolated	A different centre run by a different company.
A 2023 death at Colnbrook	Colnbrook has been operated by another company since 2014.
Three deaths at HMP Lowdham Grange, March 2023	All occurred after the February 2023 handover from Serco to another operator. Usable only as an argument about contract transition risk.
The Cornwall out-of-hours general practice contract	Auditors found falsified data entries and that the company's culture discouraged whistleblowing, but neither found patient harm or deaths, and the clinical review found no evidence the service was systematically unsafe. Presenting it as a deaths case invites immediate rebuttal.
Reported multi-billion pound pandemic contact tracing payments	The parliamentary report relied on does not name Serco once. The claim has been rated partly false by an independent fact-checking organisation.
The \$300,000 abatement figure from the Australian health services audit	Refers to the health services contractor, not Serco. Widely misattributed.
A United States False Claims Act case	Decided in the company's favour.
The British Columbia medical services plan contract	A different Maximus subsidiary, in health administration, not acquired by AKG.
Conduct by MAX Solutions before the 2023 to 2024 acquisition	That is Maximus's conduct. AKG acquired the entity; it did not commit the earlier conduct. At least some historic allegations were retracted, with a written apology stating that allegations of fraudulent practices were unfounded and false.
Solitary confinement findings at Mount Eden	These appear in inspections conducted after Serco's operation ended.
A Victorian tribunal case listed under human rights involving a MAX entity	It is an age discrimination case, not disability. Disability is not raised anywhere in the judgment, the claim was dismissed for want of jurisdiction, and the tribunal expressly noted there was no suggestion of any impropriety.
A 2014 mass-casualty inquest in which an AKG subsidiary is mentioned	Two mentions across 495 pages, in one sentence placing a person at an appointment. The company was not a party, gave no evidence, and appears in none of the 45 recommendations.
An inquest in which a MAX entity provided case support	Pre-acquisition, and exculpatory. The coroner made no criticism, found a detailed assessment had been conducted, said the provider had largely achieved its goal, and commended all of the staff for their efforts. No recommendations were made at all.

Part 7 — The limits of this record

The following matters were identified during compilation and could not be obtained from a primary source. Nothing in the body of this document rests on any of them. They are listed so that a reader knows the record is incomplete, and knows in which direction.

Matters retrieved since the first version of this document

Four matters listed as unretrieved in the first version have since been obtained from primary sources and are now in the body: the Blanket findings in full, the unread section of the Chegeni Nejad findings, the Bin Zaini findings, and the Dongrin findings. Two of those four were favourable to the operator. One of them, Dongrin, is now the most severe finding in this record. Both outcomes are recorded.

Matters identified but still not retrieved

The 2011 coronial findings into the three Villawood deaths, held by a court registry that does not publish findings from that period online, and which remain the only entry in this document stated without quotation. A 2014 Prevention of Future Deaths report whose recommendations a later coroner found had not been implemented before a further death. Two New Zealand coronial matters from the Mount Eden period, one involving a man reported to have asked for medical help five times and waited seventeen days to be seen, which would be the closest available analogue to a disability-related death through denied healthcare access. Six further United Kingdom Prevention of Future Deaths reports addressed to Serco, whose existence and addressees are verified but which exist only as scanned images without a text layer. A death in custody at Auckland South Corrections Facility in the six months to 31 March 2021, which the Inspectorate states it investigated separately. Formal written requests for several of these have been prepared.

Searches that could not be completed

The Australian parliamentary full-text database and the British and Irish legal information institute both blocked automated access. The United Kingdom information regulator's enforcement register is not machine readable. Nineteen confidential and thirty-four scanned parliamentary submissions could not be read, of which two are of direct interest. Sixty-six of seventy-nine judgments returned by the case law search on the acquired entities were not retrieved. The current status of the Ontario criminal proceedings has not been checked since 12 May 2026 and the statement in the campaign's separate contractor oversight addendum that all accused remain before the courts should be re-verified before that document is distributed further.

A European thread, deliberately excluded

Serco acquired a company operating asylum accommodation in several European countries, and there is reporting of contract cancellations and serious allegations in that sector. It is not included here at all, for two reasons. The allegations as summarised may refer to facilities in countries already covered in this document rather than to the European operation. And the acquisition date has not been established, so it is not known whether Serco owned the company at the time of the events described. Until both are resolved, none of it can be used.

A note on method, for anyone checking this work

Two negative results in the compilation of this document turned out to be artefacts of text extraction truncating long documents partway through. In one case a judgment was reported to contain no mention of a company when the full text mentioned it twenty-three times. Any negative result on a long document should be treated as unproven unless the length of text extracted has been checked against the page count. That is how the error was caught here, and it is recorded so that anyone repeating this work does not make it.

A closing note on method

Every item in this document was checked against the body that made the finding, or is explicitly marked where it was not. Findings favourable to the companies appear alongside findings against them, because a record that omitted them would not be a record. Fifteen matters that would have made this document look stronger were excluded because they concern other companies, were decided in the companies' favour, or are not what they appear, and they are listed at Part 6 rather than dropped.

This version corrects four statements in the first. One framing of a contractual relationship was contradicted by the primary document and has been removed. A characterisation of one company's record was falsified and has been replaced with a weaker and more defensible one. Two newly retrieved findings favourable to an operator have been added. One newly retrieved finding, the most severe in this document, has been added.

This is offered as an evidence base, not as a conclusion. Where the evidence supports a conclusion strongly, that should be clear. Where it is incomplete or contradictory, that should be equally clear.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com — albertadisabilitysystembreakdown.netlify.app
Compiled July 2026. General information, not legal advice. Free to share, print and post. Criminal charges referred to in the campaign's separate contractor oversight addendum are allegations that have not been proven in court.